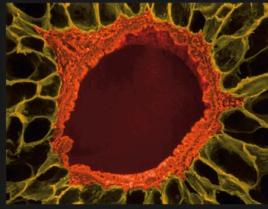


EXCHANGE IN THE BODY TISSUES

Oxygen levels are higher in the blood than in surrounding tissues. The difference in levels forces oxygen to break its bonds to the haemoglobin in red blood cells and diffuse out of the blood into the adjacent cells. The reverse applies to carbon dioxide, which diffuses from the tissue into the blood plasma.

6 Oxygenated blood is carried through tissues in capillaries thinner than hair



BRONCHIOLE AND ALVEOLI

This microview shows a cross-sectioned bronchiole (red) surrounded by alveoli that have been cut through, so that they resemble air bubbles in a sponge.

7 Arriving red blood cells are rich in oxygen, which is bound to haemoglobin in the body of each cell

8 Oxygen leaves the haemoglobin within the blood cells, and diffuses across capillary walls and into tissue cells

9 Carbon dioxide diffuses out of tissue cells, across wall of blood capillary, and into blood plasma

